

Spanish A1 — Week 1 Student Overview

Crescere | Beginner Spanish | Week 1

Welcome to your first week of Spanish.

What You Will Learn This Week

This week is about getting your voice into Spanish. You are not going to be fluent by the end of Week 1 — that is not what Week 1 is for. The goal is to say something real in Spanish, get corrected, and walk away with a foundation you can actually build on.

Here is what we will cover:

- **How Spanish sounds.** Spanish has five vowels, and each has exactly one clean sound — very different from English. You will learn to hear and produce them in Session 1. This matters more than you might think — clean vowels make everything else more natural.
 - **How to greet someone.** Formal and informal. When to say *tú* and when to say *usted*.
 - **How to say who you are.** Your name, where you're from, your nationality, and what you do.
 - **The verb *ser* (to be).** The most important verb you will learn this week. You will learn all six present-tense forms and use them in real sentences.
 - **Numbers 1–100.** You will learn 1–20 in Session 1. The rest are in the homework files, with the full pattern explained step by step.
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What You Will Be Able to Say by Friday

By the end of Session 2, you should be able to say something like:

¡Hola! Me llamo [name]. Soy de [city/country]. Soy [nationality]. Soy [profession].

Hi! My name is [name]. I'm from [city/country]. I'm [nationality]. I'm a [profession].

You will also be able to ask:

¿Cómo te llamas? ¿De dónde eres? ¿A qué te dedicas?

What's your name? Where are you from? What do you do?

That is a real exchange. Session 1 builds the vocabulary and verb; Session 2 puts it together into a conversation.

What to Practice Between Sessions

After Session 1 — before Session 2:

1. **Say the *ser* conjugation out loud from memory.** *soy, eres, es, somos, sois, son*. Say it three times. Then cover it and say it from memory. This is the most important practice task this week.
2. **Practice numbers 1–30.** They are in your Session 1 homework. Count up, count down, count by fives.
3. **Say your introduction out loud at least three times.** In the mirror, in the car, wherever. The goal is to say it without looking at your notes.

4. **Glance at the alphabet reference.** You do not need to memorize it before Session 2 — just know it exists.

After Session 2 — before Session 3:

1. **Work through the numbers 31–100.** Your Session 2 homework explains the pattern. Unlike French, Spanish 31–99 are completely regular — tens + y + unit. Once you see the logic it takes about 10 minutes to learn.
 2. **Write your five-sentence introduction in Spanish.** Instructions in the Session 2 homework.
 3. **Say it out loud one more time from memory.**
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A Note About Ser and Estar

You may already know or have heard that Spanish has two verbs that both mean "to be" — *ser* and *estar*. This week we are only learning *ser*.

The distinction between them is the most important grammar point in all of Spanish A1. We cover it in full in Week 2 — with time and context to actually understand it. If you are curious and want to look it up ahead of time, go ahead. But do not worry if it does not click yet. Week 2 is designed to explain it from scratch.

A Note on Expectations

This course is taught speaking-first. That means Session 1 will feel fast. You will hear things you cannot yet reproduce perfectly, and you will be asked to speak before you feel fully ready.

That is the method. It is intentional.

Speaking a new language feels strange. Every person in your cohort is in the same position. Mistakes are expected — they are how the learning works. The only thing that slows progress is staying quiet.

Say it wrong, get corrected, say it again. That is the whole method.

Vocabulary to Know Before Week 2

You will find the full Week 1 vocabulary list in your Week 1 Vocabulary Reference. The most important items for Session 3 (the start of Week 2) are:

- All six forms of *ser* — from memory, without looking
- Your complete introduction: name, origin, profession, nationality
- Basic greetings and when to use each register
- Numbers 1–30 solid; 31–100 by pattern

You do not need to have the full nationality and profession vocabulary memorized. Focus on knowing your own nationality and profession in Spanish.

Crescere — Spanish A1 Week 1 / Questions? Contact your instructor.